



LARGE RODENTS



Chipmunks



Size of a sheep!

The capybara is the largest rodent in the world. It is a relative of the guinea pig.

Most rodents are small and look like mice, but some are much bigger. There are two sorts of large rodents—those that look like squirrels and those, such as porcupines, that look like pigs. Rodents' teeth get worn down by gnawing, and all rodents have front teeth that keep growing throughout their lives.

A porcupine can hear fruit drop to the ground several yards away.

Porcupines chew old bones to keep their teeth sharp.

Busy nibblers



European red squirrel



Chinchilla



Rock cavy



Springhare



Woodchuck



The lion lost

A porcupine will run backward and stick its quills into an attacker's face!

Hollow, striped quill

The nest, or drey, is about the size of a football.

Angry African porcupines stamp their back feet to rattle their quills. This tells other animals to go away.

The sharp quills only stick up when the porcupine is attacked.

